**FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING CD23731**

**REPORT**

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# RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE

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## BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this report titled "Film Making and Radio Podcasting CD23731" is the bonafide work of MADHUMITHA KB(231701031) who carried out the work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported herein does not form part of any other thesis or dissertation on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or anyother candidate.


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# CHAPTER 1
# INTRODUCTION

Film making is a creative form of visual communication that combines storytelling, acting, cinematography, sound, lighting and editing to communicate an idea or experience to an audience. A short film presents a complete story within a limited duration, so every scene must contribute to the central idea. Radio podcasting, on the other hand, communicates stories through audio elements such as narration, dialogue, music, sound effects and silence. Both forms depend on planning, creativity and effective storytelling.

The project titled “MAATRAM” is an emotional short film developed as part of the Film Making and Radio Podcasting course (CD23731) in the Department of Computer Science and Design, Rajalakshmi Engineering College. The film follows a young woman named Nakshatra at three stages of her life: as a curious child of three or four, as a confident child of ten or eleven, and as a twenty-two-year-old working adult.

The story begins in the present, where twenty-two-year-old Nakshatra is working late at night, surrounded by deadlines and responsibilities. When she closes her laptop, an old childhood photograph reminds her of the person she used to be. Through two flashbacks, the film shows how her childhood curiosity developed into a clear love for dance and stage speaking, and how these interests gradually moved to the background as work, money and routine took over her life.

The film does not suggest that Nakshatra should quit her job or abandon her responsibilities. Its message is that a person does not have to choose between responsibility and personal dreams. Nakshatra learns that she can continue working while also making time for the things she loves.

The project is designed as a visual short film that can also be adapted into a radio podcast. In the podcast version, the visual elements of the film are replaced by narration, voice performance, ambient sound, music and silence.

# CHAPTER 2
# PROJECT OVERVIEW

The main idea of MAATRAM is to explore what happens to the child we used to be when we grow up. Instead of relying on a plot with a single dramatic event, the film develops through memory, comparison and gradual realization. The audience is introduced to Nakshatra in her present life and is then taken into her past through objects that trigger memories, namely a childhood photograph and an old video recording.

The film is structured around three versions of the same character. The child version represents curiosity, the pre-teen version represents self-discovery, and the adult version represents responsibility. The conflict is internal. Nakshatra has not failed in life; she has become so focused on being responsible that she has stopped making time for herself.

A childhood park appears repeatedly in the film as a symbolic location. It is where she played as a child and where she now goes only to take a break from work. The film concludes with a dance performance shared between the eleven-year-old and the twenty-two-year-old Nakshatra, showing that a dream paused in the past can be continued in the present.

The project uses a small number of characters and a limited set of locations, including a room, a childhood home, a stage or auditorium, a park and a dance space. Everyday objects such as a laptop, mobile phone, photograph and paintbrush carry much of the emotional meaning. This keeps the production practical while allowing several film-making techniques, such as flashbacks, match cuts, parallel editing and sound bridges, to be demonstrated.

# CHAPTER 3
# TITLE – MAATRAM

The Tamil word “MAATRAM” is commonly understood as “change”. In this film, the title is not limited to that single meaning. It refers to several different kinds of change that take place as a person grows, and each of them is represented in Nakshatra’s journey.

## 3.1 Kinds of Change Represented

- Childhood to adulthood: the physical and emotional growth of Nakshatra across three ages.
- Curiosity to responsibility: the child who wanted to try everything becomes an adult focused on duties and deadlines.
- Freedom to routine: playing in the park and exploring freely is replaced by fixed working hours and repeated daily patterns.
- Exploration to specialization: from painting, drawing, singing and many other activities, she narrows down to dance and stage speaking.
- Passion to practicality: activities that once made her feel alive become secondary to work, bills and EMIs.
- Dreams pursued to dreams paused: her hobbies are set aside as her responsibilities increase.
- Finally, rediscovering oneself: she recognizes what has changed and chooses to bring the missing part of herself back.

## 3.2 The Deeper Meaning

The film does not show Nakshatra changing into a completely different person. Instead, she realizes that she has changed, and that in the process she has moved away from parts of herself that once mattered to her. The change she experiences is therefore gradual and largely unnoticed until the photograph and the old video make her look back.

Her final transformation is not becoming somebody new. It is rediscovering herself. She continues to work and fulfil her responsibilities, but she also makes space for dance and creativity again. In this sense, the title describes both what happened to her over the years and what she decides to do about it.

***MAATRAM is not about changing who we are. It is about recognizing what has changed within us and finding our way back to ourselves.***

# CHAPTER 4
# GENRE

MAATRAM belongs to the Emotional Drama, Coming-of-Age and Inspirational Short Film genres. The film is driven by character and emotion rather than by plot twists or external danger. The audience is expected to connect with Nakshatra through recognition of her situation, not through tension or suspense.

### 4.1 Emotional Drama

The central conflict is internal. Nakshatra experiences exhaustion, nostalgia and a quiet sense of having lost something without knowing exactly when. The drama comes from the contrast between who she is now and who she was as a child.

### 4.2 Coming-of-Age

The film follows the same person across three stages of growth, from curiosity to self-discovery and then to responsibility. The coming-of-age element is unusual because the final realization occurs in adulthood, when Nakshatra understands what growing up cost her and what she can bring back.

### 4.3 Inspirational

The film ends on a hopeful note. It does not present an unrealistic transformation. Nakshatra keeps her job and her responsibilities, and simply makes room for her interests again.

The major elements that drive the film are:

- Emotion and character development
- Memories and nostalgia
- Family and childhood
- Personal realization and self-discovery
- The conflict between responsibility and passion

# CHAPTER 5
# OBJECTIVES

The main objective of the project is to create an emotionally engaging short film using fundamental film-making techniques, while exploring how personal interests can coexist with professional responsibilities. The project also aims to demonstrate how camera work, lighting, sound and editing can be used to distinguish different stages of a character's life.

The specific objectives are:

- To develop an emotionally engaging short-film narrative.
- To explore the relationship between childhood dreams and adult responsibilities.
- To portray character development through three different stages of life.
- To demonstrate visual storytelling through flashbacks.
- To use cinematography to distinguish childhood and adulthood.
- To use lighting and colour to establish different emotional moods.
- To use sound and music to connect different timelines.
- To use editing techniques such as match cuts and parallel editing.
- To show emotional development without relying excessively on dialogue.
- To explore how personal interests can coexist with professional responsibilities.
- To understand screenplay writing and scene development.
- To develop practical skills in cinematography, acting, editing and sound design.
- To adapt the visual story into an audio/radio podcast format.

# CHAPTER 6
# STORY DEVELOPMENT

The story originated from a simple question: “What happens to the child we used to be when we grow up?” Many people begin life curious about everything, slowly identify what they love, and then find that work and responsibility leave little time for those interests. The film was developed to represent this experience honestly, without turning it into a story of failure or rebellion.

## 6.1 Development of the Three Nakshatras

The character was developed in three stages so that the audience could see how she changes. The three-or-four-year-old Nakshatra represents the desire to experience everything. The ten-or-eleven-year-old Nakshatra represents the moment when she begins to understand what she genuinely loves. The twenty-two-year-old Nakshatra represents responsibility, independence and the gradual loss of personal time.

## 6.2 Narrative Structure

The story begins in the present with Nakshatra working late at night. After a work notification and a long day of deadlines, she closes her laptop and notices an old childhood photograph. This object triggers the first memory. The film moves into a flashback of Nakshatra as a young child, exploring creative activities with her mother.

After returning to the present, an old video of her performing on stage as a ten-or-eleven-year-old triggers the second memory. She realizes that her younger self had already discovered what she loved. The comparison between the past and present forms the emotional core of the story.

## 6.3 The Park as a Recurring Symbol

The park was introduced as a recurring visual symbol. In childhood, it was a place for play. As an adult, Nakshatra goes there only to get fresh air from work. The same place therefore represents two very different stages of her life and allows the film to connect past and present visually.

## 6.4 The Realization

The story reaches its conclusion when Nakshatra understands that she does not need to abandon her career. The realization is intended to be gradual, developing through the photograph, the video, the park and the discovery of old objects. She can continue working and still make space for her dreams.

# CHAPTER 7
# STORY SYNOPSIS

### 7.1 Beginning

Twenty-two-year-old Nakshatra is working late at night in her room. Her surroundings show a life dominated by work, deadlines, money and routine. A notification related to work and financial responsibilities, such as an EMI, appears on her phone. She finishes her work, closes her laptop and takes a moment to breathe.

### 7.2 First Memory

While clearing her desk, she notices an old childhood photograph. She looks at it for a while, and the photograph triggers her first memory.

### 7.3 First Flashback

The film moves to Nakshatra at the age of three or four. She is highly curious and energetic, moving from one activity to another. She paints, draws, dances, sings, speaks on a make-believe stage and plays. Her mother encourages her at every step and never limits her to one activity. Her attitude is clear: she wants to try everything.

### 7.4 Present

The film returns to the present. Nakshatra goes back to her routine of work, notifications and pending tasks. She visits a park, but only for a short break from work. The place where she once played freely is now a place where she continues to think about her responsibilities.

### 7.5 Second Memory

An old video of her performing as a ten-or-eleven-year-old appears on her phone or device. Watching the video triggers the second memory.

### 7.6 Second Flashback

The film shows the eleven-year-old Nakshatra preparing backstage, performing a dance and speaking on stage. By this age, she has narrowed her many childhood interests down to two that make her feel alive: dance and stage speaking. She is also shown studying, playing and spending time with family and friends. She is talented, confident and happy.

### 7.7 Present Realization

Back in the present, Nakshatra compares her younger self with her current life. She has not failed, but she has slowly stopped making time for herself. Her dreams have been pushed aside by responsibility.

### 7.8 Park Sequence

The childhood park becomes the point where the past and present meet. Sounds and images from childhood connect with her present-day surroundings, and she begins to see the place differently.

### 7.9 Decision

After finding old childhood objects, Nakshatra understands that she does not need to quit her job or abandon her responsibilities. Her realization is: “I can work and still pursue the things I love.”

### 7.10 Transformation

She begins to incorporate dance, creativity and personal interests into her routine. She continues working, but she now makes time for herself. The film shows this balance being built gradually.

### 7.11 Final Dance

The eleven-year-old Nakshatra performs the first half of an old dance. Through a match cut, the twenty-two-year-old Nakshatra continues the movement and completes the remaining half. The dance represents the continuation of a dream across time.

# CHAPTER 8
# CHARACTERS

MAATRAM has one central character presented at three different ages, along with one important supporting character. The distinction between the three versions of Nakshatra is central to the story, so each is developed with a specific emotional identity.

### 8.1 Nakshatra – Age 3/4

The youngest Nakshatra is innocent, curious, creative and energetic. She explores painting, drawing, dancing, music, singing, stage speaking, creative activities and play, and she is always ready to try new interests. Her relationship with her mother is warm and secure, and it gives her the freedom to explore.

This version represents the idea: “I want to experience everything.”

### 8.2 Nakshatra – Age 10/11

At this age, Nakshatra begins to understand herself. From the many activities she explored as a child, she gradually identifies dance and stage speaking as the activities that make her feel alive. She continues studying, playing, spending time with family and friends, and taking part in activities. She is talented, confident and happy.

This version represents the idea: “I am beginning to understand what I love.”

### 8.3 Nakshatra – Age 22

The present-day Nakshatra is hardworking, responsible and independent. Her life is dominated by work, deadlines, money, bills, EMIs, routine and stress. She shows emotional exhaustion, and her hobbies have gradually disappeared from her daily life.

She is not portrayed as weak or unsuccessful. She is a responsible adult who has achieved stability. Her conflict is internal: she has achieved responsibility but lost balance. She has not stopped being the person she was; she has stopped making time for that person.

### 8.4 Amma

Amma is a supportive mother who encourages Nakshatra’s creativity in childhood. Instead of restricting her to one activity, she allows her to explore. She is not controlling. She represents emotional support, encouragement, childhood security and the freedom to explore.

# CHAPTER 9
# SCENE DEVELOPMENT

This chapter explains the individual scenes of MAATRAM. There are twenty-five scenes, and each is described with its location, time, characters, description, emotional purpose and cinematic approach. Where the exact shooting arrangement is not finalized, this is marked as Times of day for flashback scenes are indicative and may be adjusted according to the actual shoot.

## 9.1 Scene 1 – Working Late at Night

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Nakshatra's room |
| **Time** | Night |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | Nakshatra is seen working on her laptop late at night. The room is quiet except for typing. She looks tired but focused. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Establishes her present life as controlled by work and routine. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Static medium shot and close-ups of the laptop and keyboard. Repeated framing to show routine. |

## 9.2 Scene 2 – EMI / Work Notification

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Nakshatra's room |
| **Time** | Night |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | A notification on her phone reminds her of an EMI or work-related responsibility. She checks it and returns to work. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Shows financial and professional pressure as a constant part of her life. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Close-up of the phone screen followed by a close-up of her reaction. Notification sound as a sound cue. |

## 9.3 Scene 3 – Closing the Laptop

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Nakshatra's room |
| **Time** | Night |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | She finishes her work and closes the laptop. There is a pause as the room becomes quiet. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Creates the moment of stillness in which memory can enter the story. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Close-up of the closing laptop, then a slow shot of her face. Keyboard sound stops and silence is used. |

### 9.4 Scene 4 – Discovering the Childhood Photograph

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Nakshatra's room |
| **Time** | Night |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | While clearing her desk, she notices an old childhood photograph and picks it up. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Acts as the trigger for the first flashback. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Close-up of the photograph and her expression. The transition into the flashback is prepared with a sound bridge. |

### 9.5 Scene 5 – Flashback to 4-Year-Old Nakshatra

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Childhood home |
| **Time** | Day (flashback) |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (3/4), Amma |
| **Scene Description** | The film moves into Nakshatra's early childhood. She is energetic and moves freely from one activity to the next. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Establishes curiosity and freedom as the defining qualities of her childhood. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Wider shots, moving camera and open compositions. Warmer, softer visual tone. |

### 9.6 Scene 6– Stage Speaking

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Childhood home |
| **Time** | Day (flashback) |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (3/4), Amma |
| **Scene Description** | Using a toy microphone, she speaks as if on a stage while Amma watches and encourages her. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Introduces stage speaking, which will later become one of her two main interests. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Low-angle or child-height shots showing her confidence. Toy microphone shown in close-up. |

### 9.7Scene 7 – Return to the Present

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Nakshatra's room |
| **Time** | Night |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | Childhood laughter continues briefly as the film returns to Nakshatra in her room. She puts down the photograph and returns to her routine. |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Emotional Purpose** | Shows that the memory has stayed with her while her routine continues. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Sound bridge from childhood laughter into the room's quiet. Return to static framing. |

### 9.8 Scene 8 – 11-Year-Old Nakshatra Backstage

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | School stage / auditorium |
| **Time** | Day (flashback) |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (10/11) |
| **Scene Description** | Eleven-year-old Nakshatra waits backstage before her performance. She is nervous but confident. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Shows that she knows what she loves. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Close-ups of her face and hands. Sounds of the audience heard from beyond the curtain. |

### 9.9 Scene 9 – Dance Performance

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | School stage / auditorium |
| **Time** | Day (flashback) |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (10/11) |
| **Scene Description** | She performs a dance on stage with confidence and joy. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Shows the moment of self-discovery through dance. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Wider stage shots combined with close-ups of movement and feet. Dance music and applause. |

### 9.10Scene 10 – Return to the Present

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Nakshatra's room |
| **Time** | Night |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | The applause fades and the film returns to her in the present as the video ends. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Creates a strong contrast between her confident younger self and her tired present. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Sound bridge from applause into silence. Static close-up. |

### 9.11 Scene 11 – Comparing Past and Present

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Nakshatra's room |
| **Time** | Night |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | She looks at the photograph, the video and her work. She understands that the person in the video is still a part of her. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Presents her gradual recognition that she has lost balance, not failed. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Parallel editing between childhood images and present-day routine. Mirror shot showing her reflection. |

### 9.12 Scene 12 – Realization – She Does Not Need to Quit Work

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Nakshatra's room |
| **Time** | Day |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | She understands that the solution is not to leave her job but to make time for herself. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | The main emotional turning point of the story. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | A quiet close-up with silence. Natural light gradually increases. |

### 9.13 Scene 13 – Beginning to Dance Again

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Nakshatra's room or dance studio [TO BE FILLED] |
| **Time** | Day |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | She begins to dance again, first hesitantly and then with greater ease. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Shows her decision turning into action. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Medium and wide shots with more fluid camera movement than in earlier adult scenes. |

### 9.14 Scene 14 – Balancing Work and Hobbies

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Room / dance studio / park |
| **Time** | Day and Night |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | A short sequence shows her working, dancing, and spending time on creative activity within the same routine. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Shows that balance is possible and realistic. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Montage. Work moments and personal moments are mixed within the same sequence. |

### 9.15 Scene 15– Recreating the Old Dance

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Dance studio or open space [TO BE FILLED] |
| **Time** | Day |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | She practises the dance from the old recording, learning it again from the video. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Prepares the emotional climax. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Match on action, close-ups of feet and hand movement, and reference to the old video. |

### 9.16 Scene 16 – Final Combined Dance

| | |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Dance studio or open space [TO BE FILLED] |
| **Time** | Day |
| **Characters** | Nakshatra (10/11), Nakshatra (22) |
| **Scene Description** | The eleven-year-old performs the first half of the dance. A match cut takes the movement to the twenty-two-year-old, who completes it. |
| **Emotional Purpose** | Represents the continuation of a dream across time. |
| **Cinematic Approach** | Match cut, cross-cutting and match on action. Open, warm lighting and continuous music. |

# CHAPTER 10
# CLIMAX AND ENDING

The climax of MAATRAM is emotional rather than dramatic. It does not depend on danger or surprise. It occurs through the continuation of the dance between the two Nakshatras.

## 10.1 The Dance Continuation

The eleven-year-old Nakshatra begins performing the dance from the old recording. As the choreography reaches a specific movement, a match cut takes the film to the twenty-two-year-old Nakshatra, who performs the next movement. The music continues without interruption. The younger Nakshatra completes the first half of the dance, and the adult Nakshatra completes the second half.

## 10.2 Symbolic Significance

The two performances form one continuous dance across time. This symbolizes that the dream was never destroyed; it was only paused. The adult Nakshatra is not becoming her younger self again. She is carrying that part of herself forward into her present life.

## 10.3 The Ending

The ending shows that Nakshatra continues working while she also pursues her dreams. Her job and responsibilities remain unchanged, but her life is no longer limited to them. The film closes with the message that dreams can be paused, but they do not need a full stop.

# CHAPTER 11
# CINEMATOGRAPHY

Cinematography in MAATRAM is used to distinguish the different stages of Nakshatra's life. The visual language makes adult life feel more confined than childhood.

## 11.1 Childhood

- Wider shots to show space and freedom
- Moving camera to reflect energy and curiosity
- Open compositions
- Natural movement of the subject
- Dynamic framing

## 11.2 Adult Life

- Static compositions to reflect routine
- Close-ups that limit the space around the character
- Laptop framing and desk shots
- Repetitive camera angles
- Restricted compositions

## 11.3 Key Visual Elements

Close-up of the laptop: shows the constant presence of work in her life. Close-up of tired eyes: shows emotional exhaustion without dialogue. Phone notifications: show the pressure of deadlines and financial responsibilities. The childhood photograph and the old dance video: act as triggers for memory. The park: is framed in a similar way in childhood and adult scenes to help the audience compare them. The mirror: can be used during the realization scenes to show Nakshatra looking at herself. Dance movements: are shot with more fluid camera movement to show freedom. Match cuts: are framed with matching positions so that the transition between ages feels continuous.

Camera model, lens choice and stabilization equipment: CANON

# CHAPTER 12
# LIGHTING

The lighting strategy of MAATRAM follows the emotional development of the story rather than the requirements of a suspense film.

- Childhood: brighter, warmer and more natural lighting to create comfort and joy.
- Adult work scenes: more controlled and subdued lighting. The laptop screen can be an important light source in night scenes.
- Memories: a softer and warmer visual identity so that flashbacks feel distinct from the present.
- Realization scenes: gradually more natural light, showing her emotional change.
- Final dance: open, natural or warm lighting to represent freedom and emotional resolution.

The change in lighting across the film should be gradual, so that the visual mood follows Nakshatra’s emotional journey.

# CHAPTER 13
# SOUND DESIGN

Sound is a very important part of MAATRAM because it connects the different timelines and communicates emotion without dialogue.

### 13.1 Sounds of the Present

The adult scenes use keyboard typing, mouse clicks, phone notifications, clock ticking and laptop sounds. These repeated sounds create the feeling of a routine. Footsteps and room ambience help establish the space.

### 13.2 Sounds of the Past

Childhood scenes use laughter, Amma's voice, park ambience, children's voices and birds. The stage sequences include music, applause and audience sounds.

### 13.3 Sound Bridges

- Childhood laughter continues from the flashback into the present-day park.
- Dance music from the old video continues into the present-day dance.
- Keyboard typing becomes a repetitive pattern that represents the adult routine.

### 13.4 Silence and Music

Silence is used during Nakshatra's realizations so that the audience can absorb the emotional change. The emotional background score supports the story and is designed to evolve from restrained in the adult scenes to more open in the final dance. The details of the music used: SUTTLE MUSIC

# CHAPTER 14
# EDITING TECHNIQUES

Editing is used in MAATRAM to connect the past and present and to communicate the emotional story.

### 14.1 Flashbacks

Flashbacks move the film from the present-day Nakshatra to her younger selves. They are triggered by the photograph and the old video, so that each memory begins with an object.

### 14.2 Match Cuts

Match cuts are especially important in the final dance. For example, the eleven-year-old Nakshatra raises her hand, and the film cuts to the twenty-two-year-old Nakshatra continuing the same movement. The match cut shows two ages as parts of one continuous action.

### 14.3 Parallel Editing

Parallel editing compares childhood and adulthood. Childhood is shown through running, playing and dancing. Adult life is shown through working, typing and paying bills. This contrast helps the audience understand what has changed.

### 14.4 Montage

A montage is used to show the development of Nakshatra's interests in early childhood and, later, to show her balancing work and hobbies.

### 14.5 Cross-Cutting

Cross-cutting is used during the final dance to alternate between the younger and older Nakshatra.

### 14.6 Sound Bridges

Sound continues across a cut to connect different timelines, such as childhood laughter continuing into the present-day park.

### 14.7 Match on Action

Match on action is used wherever the same movement takes place across different ages, so that the cut appears smooth and continuous.

Editing software used: AFTER EFFECTS

# CHAPTER 15
# USE OF PROPS AND LOCATION

## 15.1 Props

The important props in the film are:

- Laptop
- Mobile phone
- Childhood photograph
- Old video
- Dance certificate
- Paintbrush and paintings
- Toy microphone
- Notebook
- Dance shoes
- Work documents
- Coffee cup
- notification

The laptop, phone, work documents, coffee cup and EMI notification represent the present. The photograph, video, certificate, paintbrush, toy microphone, notebook and dance shoes represent the past. The film uses these two groups of props to show the two sides of Nakshatra's life.

## 15.2 Locations

- Nakshatra's room: represents her adult life and work.
- Childhood home: represents her early creativity.
- School stage / auditorium: represents self-discovery.
- Park: represents the connection between childhood and adulthood.
- Dance studio: represents her decision to reconnect with her passion.

Actual filming locations: HOME

# CHAPTER 16
# RADIO PODCAST ADAPTATION

The story of MAATRAM can be adapted into a radio podcast by replacing visual information with narration, dialogue, ambient sound and music. The podcast should preserve the same emotional journey even without visuals.

The main visual elements of the film can be adapted as follows:

| Film Element | Podcast Adaptation |
|---|---|
| Childhood photograph | The narrator describes the photograph. |
| Old video | The sound of a stage performance and applause. |
| Park | Birds, children, wind and footsteps. |
| Dance | Music and the sound of foot movements. |
| Mother | Dialogue and emotional voice. |
| Flashbacks | Narration and sound transitions. |

This adaptation demonstrates the importance of sound imagination in radio storytelling. The audience must understand who Nakshatra is, how old she is in each scene, and how she feels, entirely through sound.

# CHAPTER 17
# RADIO PODCAST SCRIPT APPROACH

The podcast script is adapted from the film's screenplay and uses the following elements: a narrator, Nakshatra's voice, Amma's voice, the voice of childhood Nakshatra, ambient sound, music and silence.

The podcast can begin with the narrator describing Nakshatra working late at night, with keyboard sounds and phone notifications in the background. When she closes her laptop, the sound stops and a brief silence is used. The narrator then describes the childhood photograph, and a sound transition takes the story into the first flashback.

In the flashback sections, childhood laughter, Amma's voice and playful background music are used. The old video is presented through the sound of a stage, dance music and applause. The park is presented through birds, children's voices, wind and footsteps.

The three ages of Nakshatra are distinguished through voice performance and narration, not through visual appearance. The narrator can also clearly indicate the change of time when needed. In the final part, the dance can be described through music, footsteps and a gradual movement of the sound from the younger voice and style to the older one, ending with the message of the film.

# CHAPTER 18
# VOICE AND AUDIO PERFORMANCE

Voice performance is very important in the podcast version because the audience depends entirely on sound to understand the characters and emotions. Each Nakshatra should have a distinct voice.

- Nakshatra (3/4): energetic, playful and excited.
- Nakshatra (10/11): confident, expressive and enthusiastic.
- Nakshatra (22): initially tired, controlled and emotionally restrained. Later, more relaxed, confident and emotionally alive.
- Amma: warm, encouraging and affectionate.

The following elements are important in the performance:

- Voice modulation to show emotion and age
- Pauses to show reflection
- Emotion that feels sincere
- Natural dialogue
- Background music that supports the emotion
- Ambient sound to create the setting
- Silence during moments of realization

The change in the adult Nakshatra's voice, from restrained to relaxed, should be gradual, reflecting her gradual realization.

# CHAPTER 19
# PRODUCTION PROCESS

The production of MAATRAM is divided into three stages: pre-production, production and post-production. Specific details of equipment, software, crew and dates are marked as [TO BE FILLED].

## 19.1 Pre-Production

- Story development based on the idea of what happens to the child we used to be
- Script writing
- Character development of the three versions of Nakshatra and Amma
- Scene planning
- Location selection
- Costume planning to distinguish the three ages
- Props
- Dance choreography
- Shot planning
- Music planning
- Flashback planning

## 19.2 Production

- Shooting present-day scenes
- Shooting childhood scenes
- Capturing park scenes
- Recording dance sequences
- Recording stage sequences
- Capturing close-ups of the laptop, phone, photograph and other props
- Recording sound, including dialogue and ambient sound

## 19.3 Post-Production

- Video editing
- Flashback transitions
- Match cuts
- Colour correction to separate the timelines
- Sound design

- Background music
- Dialogue editing
- Final dance synchronization
- Titles and credits
- Exporting the final film

# CHAPTER 20
# CHALLENGES FACED

The following are the main challenges and production considerations for MAATRAM. They are described as potential considerations unless they are confirmed from the actual production. [TO BE FILLED: confirm which of these were faced in practice.]

- Portraying three ages of the same character and maintaining visual continuity between them.
- Finding suitable locations for childhood and adult scenes.
- Making flashbacks visually distinct from present-day scenes.
- Synchronizing the two dance performances and creating a seamless match cut between the eleven-year-old and twenty-two-year-old.
- Synchronizing music and dance movements.
- Maintaining emotional continuity across the different timelines.
- Balancing dialogue and visual storytelling.
- Recording childhood and adult scenes with consistent visual quality.
- Creating realistic work-life scenes without making them repetitive.
- Recording the podcast adaptation, including distinct voices for each age.

Each of these considerations requires planning in pre-production and careful coordination between camera, performance and editing.

# CHAPTER 21
# LEARNING OUTCOMES

Through this project, several practical and creative skills are developed:

- Screenplay writing
- Character development
- Emotional storytelling
- Scene planning
- Cinematography
- Lighting
- Sound design
- Editing
- Flashback construction
- Match cuts
- Performance direction
- Dance synchronization
- Visual symbolism
- Location planning
- Audio storytelling
- Podcast adaptation
- Team coordination

The project also demonstrates that emotional stories can be told effectively through objects, sound and images, without depending heavily on dialogue. The podcast adaptation provides additional experience in voice performance, narration and audio editing, and shows how the same story must be presented differently in different media.

# CHAPTER 22
# EXPECTED OUTCOME

The expected outcome of the project is a short emotional film titled MAATRAM, supported by a radio podcast adaptation. The film is expected to:

- Connect with young adults
- Encourage reflection on childhood interests
- Explore the effect of adulthood and responsibilities
- Show that career and personal interests can coexist
- Create an emotional connection through the three versions of Nakshatra
- Use visual storytelling instead of excessive dialogue
- End with the symbolic continuation of the childhood dance

The expected emotional response is reflection and recognition. The audience should see something of their own experience in Nakshatra's journey and consider what they may have set aside as they grew older.

# CHAPTER 23
# CONCLUSION

The MAATRAM project demonstrates how film-making can communicate an emotional idea through character development, flashbacks, cinematography, sound, editing, music, performance and symbolism. A simple situation, a young woman closing her laptop after a long day, becomes the starting point for a story about identity, memory and growing up.

The three versions of Nakshatra represent different stages of personal development. The three-or-four-year-old represents curiosity. The ten-or-eleven-year-old represents self-discovery. The twenty-two-year-old represents responsibility and adulthood. The final dance represents the connection between all three: the younger Nakshatra begins the dance and the older Nakshatra completes it.

This symbolizes that growing up does not necessarily mean abandoning childhood dreams. Nakshatra does not quit her job or leave her responsibilities. She learns that she can continue to work and still make space for herself.

The radio podcast adaptation further shows how the same story can be communicated through narration, dialogue, sound effects and music. Overall, MAATRAM provides practical experience in both film-making and radio podcasting, and shows the importance of emotion, timing and sound in media production.

MAATRAM is not about becoming a different person. It is about finding the parts of yourself that were left behind and bringing them into the life you live today.

***"Dreams can be paused, but they do not need a full stop."***

***"We live only once."***